

Necklace orchid



Long strings of flowers have a sweet scent to attract insect pollinators.

Frogs, insects, and even crabs can be found living in bromeliad pools.



Waterproof leaves come in many colors and collect pools of water at their center.



Bromeliad

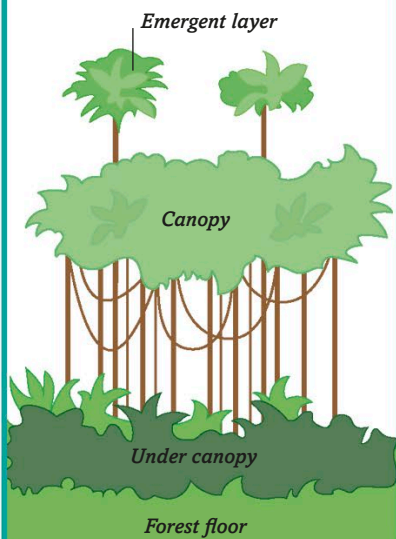
These yellow flowers resemble the golden gowns of dancing ladies, giving this orchid its name.



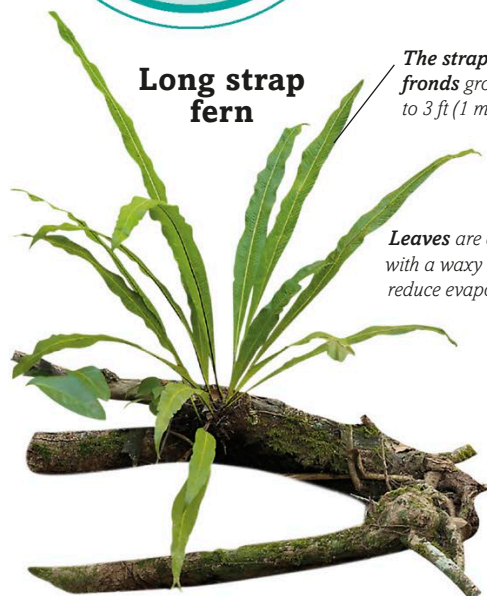
Dancing ladies orchid

LIVING LAYERS

Rain forests are divided into four layers, each with its own unique set of plants and animals. Fungi living on the dark forest floor break down plant matter. Shrubs and bushes in the under canopy shelter small animals and predators in the shadow of a full, leafy canopy, which is home to birds and climbing animals. Emergent trees tower above all others, housing high fliers such as eagles and bats.



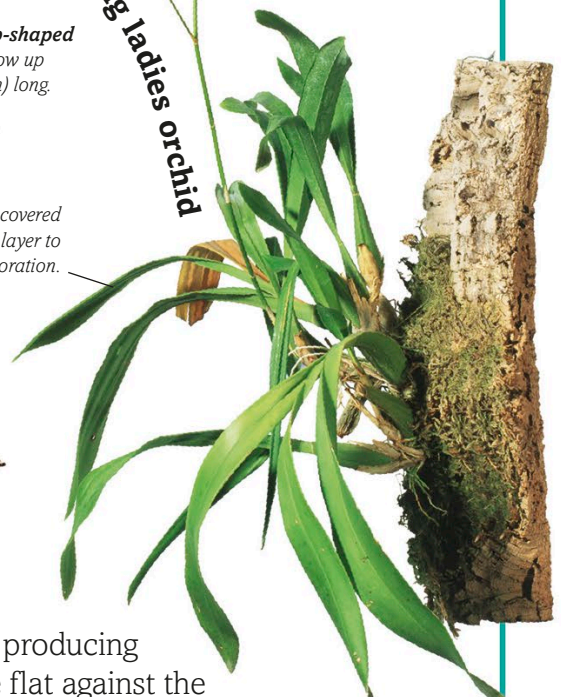
Male bees attack the orchid, mistaking it for a rival, and pollinating it as they do so.



Long strap fern

The strap-shaped fronds grow up to 3 ft (1 m) long.

Leaves are covered with a waxy layer to reduce evaporation.



650 plants known as air plants. They take their name from their ability to use their leaves to absorb water from the air around them. Many epiphytic **orchids** grow in humid environments such as rain forests. They collect moisture from the air, too, but use fleshy roots to do this, rather than their leaves. The **staghorn fern** also uses its roots to take in water from its humid

environment, producing fronds that lie flat against the tree trunk to prevent them from drying out. The crowns of fronds at the top of this plant and other epiphytic ferns, such as the **bird's nest fern** and the **long strap fern**, also collect water and falling leaves, which provide much-needed nutrients for these plants.